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The 1-Hour Apartment Reset

A Guided, Hands-On System
for Resetting Your Space

\$9 CAD

What's Your Reset Style?

Answer these 5 questions to discover your ideal reset approach. Check the option that sounds most like you.

1. When your space is messy, you usually...

- A) Feel overwhelmed and want to tackle it all at once
- B) Pick one room and focus there until it's done
- C) Do a quick tidy-up every day so it never gets bad

2. Your ideal Saturday morning involves...

- A) A big cleaning blitz with music blasting
- B) Methodically working through your to-do list
- C) A calm morning because everything's already tidy

3. When you buy something new, you...

- A) Find a spot for it later (or never)
- B) Immediately designate a specific home for it
- C) Already have a system - one in, one out

4. Your junk drawer is...

- A) Overflowing - what junk drawer isn't?
- B) Organized by category with dividers
- C) Barely a thing - you deal with items as they come

5. How do you feel about timers?

- A) Love them! They create urgency
- B) Helpful for staying on track in each zone
- C) Don't need them - I do a little every day

Your Reset Type

Mostly A's - The Sprinter

You love a big, energetic reset. Use the full 1-hour plan and blast through it with a timer and your favourite playlist.

Mostly B's - The Zoner

You work best room by room. Follow the chapters in order, completing each zone fully before moving on.

Mostly C's - The Maintainer

You prefer small daily habits. Focus on Chapter 7's daily and weekly routines to keep things consistently tidy.

Chapter 1

Introduction

The 1-Hour Reset Concept

Your Apartment Isn't Messy

It's just unfinished.

A reset isn't about deep cleaning. It isn't about perfection. A reset is the intentional completion of your spaces - bringing each room back to its baseline state so you can breathe, think, and actually enjoy being home.

In the next hour, you'll move through your apartment zone by zone, spending just the right amount of time in each space. Every task is timed, every action is specific, and every step brings you closer to that satisfying feeling of completion.

Do This Now

Set a timer on your phone for 60 minutes. Put on comfortable shoes and your favourite playlist. Grab a garbage bag and a laundry basket. You're ready.

Here's your schedule:

- Entryway: 15 minutes
- Kitchen: 20 minutes
- Living Room: 15 minutes
- Bathroom: 10 minutes

Designer Tip

The secret to a great reset is momentum. Don't stop to organize a drawer or rearrange furniture. Just complete each task and move on. You can always come back for the details.

Chapter 2

Entryway

15 Minutes

Threshold Psychology - First Impressions Matter

Before You Start

Rate the current state of your entryway on a scale of 1 to 5:

- 1 - Total chaos
- 2 - Pretty messy
- 3 - Okay-ish
- 4 - Mostly tidy
- 5 - Already great

My entryway's biggest problem is:

Entryway Tasks

Your entryway sets the emotional tone for your entire home. In environmental psychology, this is called threshold psychology - the first space you see when you walk in affects your mood for the rest of the evening.

Shoes (3 min)

- Line up all shoes neatly or store in a shoe rack
- Maximum 3 pairs visible - store the rest in a closet
- Toss any shoes that are worn out or you haven't worn in 6 months

Coats & Bags (4 min)

- Hang coats on hooks at 150cm (5 ft) height
- One coat per hook - no doubling up
- Move out-of-season coats to a closet

Mail & Keys (4 min)

- Create a 'landing strip' - a narrow shelf, hooks, and tray by the door
- Place keys in the tray immediately when you walk in
- Sort mail: recycle junk, file important items, action items in a stack

Wipe & Sweep (4 min)

- Wipe down any surfaces (shelf, table, mirror)
- Quick sweep or vacuum the entryway floor
- Shake out the doormat if you have one

Designer Tip

The 'landing strip' concept: a narrow shelf (30-45cm deep) with hooks above and a small tray for keys and change. This single addition can transform a chaotic entryway into a calm transition zone.

Before: Shoes scattered, coats piled, keys missing

After: 3 pairs lined up, coats hung, keys in tray, floor swept

Chapter Checklist

Shoes lined up (max 3 pairs visible)

Coats hung on hooks (one per hook)

Landing strip set up with key tray

Surfaces wiped, floor swept

Chapter 3

Kitchen

20 Minutes

The Working Triangle

Before You Start

Rate the current state of your kitchen on a scale of 1 to 5:

- 1 - Total chaos
- 2 - Pretty messy
- 3 - Okay-ish
- 4 - Mostly tidy
- 5 - Already great

My kitchen's biggest problem is:

Kitchen Tasks

The kitchen is the heart of your home and usually the first place that shows clutter. The 'working triangle' concept (sink, stove, fridge) means keeping the paths between these three points clear and functional.

Dishes (5 min)

- Load dishwasher or hand-wash everything in the sink
- Don't let 'just a few' sit there - do them all now
- Dry and put away anything on the drying rack

Clear Paper & Mail (3 min)

- Remove all paper, mail, and flyers from counters
- Recycle what you can, file the rest
- Counters are for cooking, not collecting

Appliances (5 min)

- Only daily-use items stay on the counter (kettle, coffee maker)
- Store everything else: toaster, blender, stand mixer
- If you haven't used it this week, it goes in a cabinet

Wipe Surfaces (4 min)

- Wipe all countertops with a damp cloth
- Wipe stovetop and any splatter zones
- Quick wipe of cabinet fronts if needed

Quick Floor (3 min)

- Sweep or Swiffer the main traffic areas
- Focus on around the stove and under the table
- Don't move furniture - just get the visible areas

Do This Now

Look at your kitchen counter right now. Count the items. If there are more than 5 items that aren't daily-use, grab a box and clear them off. You can decide where they live later.

Designer Tip

The 2-minute daily kitchen habit: After your last meal of the day, wipe the counters and put away any items that migrated to the surfaces. Two minutes prevents two hours of weekend cleaning.

Before: Dishes in sink, cluttered counters, crumbs on floor

After: Clean sink, clear counters, swept floor, only essentials visible

Chapter Checklist

All dishes washed and put away

Paper and mail cleared from counters

Only daily-use appliances on counter

All surfaces wiped clean

Floor swept in main areas

Chapter 4

Living Room

15 Minutes

Focal Point Hierarchy

Before You Start

Rate the current state of your living room on a scale of 1 to 5:

- 1 - Total chaos
- 2 - Pretty messy
- 3 - Okay-ish
- 4 - Mostly tidy
- 5 - Already great

My living room's biggest problem is:

Living Room Tasks

Every room needs a focal point - the first thing your eye is drawn to when you enter. In your living room, this might be a piece of art, a bookshelf, or a window view. A reset clears the visual noise so your focal point can shine.

Clear Surfaces (4 min)

- Maximum 3 items per surface (coffee table, side tables, shelves)
- Remove cups, plates, wrappers, random objects
- The '3-item rule' creates visual calm without feeling empty

Cushions & Throws (3 min)

- Fluff and arrange sofa cushions
- 'Karate chop' decorative pillows for that designer look
- Fold throws neatly over the arm or back of the sofa

Remotes & Cables (3 min)

- Gather all remotes into one basket or tray
- Tuck visible cables behind furniture
- If you have a charging station, use it

Anchor Item (5 min)

- Identify your room's focal point / anchor piece
- Clear the area around it so it stands out
- Straighten art, adjust lighting to highlight it

Do This Now

Stand in your living room doorway. What's the first thing you see? If it's clutter, you need to redefine your focal point. Clear the area around your best piece and make it the star.

Designer Tip

The 'karate chop' pillow technique: hold the pillow upright and give the top center a firm chop with the side of your hand. This creates a professional indent that says 'this was placed with intention.'

Chapter Checklist

All surfaces have 3 items or fewer

Cushions fluffed, throws folded

Remotes corralled, cables tucked

Anchor item visible and highlighted

Chapter 5

Bathroom

10 Minutes

Minimal Counter Syndrome

Before You Start

Rate the current state of your bathroom on a scale of 1 to 5:

- 1 - Total chaos
- 2 - Pretty messy
- 3 - Okay-ish
- 4 - Mostly tidy
- 5 - Already great

My bathroom's biggest problem is:

Bathroom Tasks

Bathrooms are small spaces with big visual impact. 'Minimal counter syndrome' is the idea that fewer items on the counter makes the entire room feel cleaner and more spacious, even if nothing else changes.

Counter Items (3 min)

- Maximum 3 items on the counter (soap, toothbrush holder, one more)
- Everything else goes in a cabinet or under the sink
- Wipe the counter after clearing it

Under-Sink Sort (3 min)

- Quick sort: toss expired products, empty bottles
- Group like items together (cleaning, hair, skin)
- No need to organize perfectly - just visible categories

Shower/Tub Edge (2 min)

- Remove bottles you don't use regularly
- Rinse the edges and wipe away soap residue
- Aim for 3-4 bottles max on the shower edge

Mirror & Faucet Wipe (2 min)

- Wipe the mirror with a dry cloth or glass cleaner
- Polish the faucet - this one detail makes everything look cleaner
- Quick wipe of the toilet exterior

Designer Tip

A shiny faucet is the bathroom equivalent of a made bed. It's one small detail that tricks your brain into thinking the whole room is clean. Always end your bathroom reset with the faucet.

Chapter Checklist

Counter has 3 items or fewer

Under-sink area sorted, expired items tossed

Shower edge cleared to 3-4 bottles

Mirror and faucet sparkling

Chapter 6

What Not to Buy

Saving Money & Space

The Two-Week Wait Rule

Before you buy anything for your home, wait two weeks. If you still want it after 14 days, it's probably a genuine need. Most impulse purchases fade in importance within a few days.

Remember: 'Measure twice, buy once.' Every item you bring into your home needs a place to live. If you can't identify that place before you buy, you don't need it yet.

Do This Now

Think of the last thing you bought for your home. Ask yourself the 4 questions below. Would it pass?

4 Questions Before Buying

1. Do I actually need this, or do I just want it right now?
2. Where exactly will this live in my home?
3. Do I already own something that does the same thing?
4. Will I still want this in 6 months?

My most recent impulse purchase was:

Did it pass all 4 questions?

Designer Tip

The best-designed small spaces have fewer, better things. Instead of buying 5 cheap organizers, invest in one beautiful piece that serves multiple purposes. Quality over quantity, always.

Chapter 7

Keeping It Reset

Building Lasting Habits

The Maintenance System

A reset is powerful, but it's temporary. The real magic happens when you build tiny habits that keep your space consistently reset. Here are four levels of maintenance:

Daily: The 2-Minute Habit

After your last meal or task of the day, spend 2 minutes doing a quick wipe-and-clear. Wipe kitchen counters, put away anything that migrated from its home, and do a visual scan of each room. That's it. Two minutes.

Weekly: The 10-Minute Tune-Up

Pick one day a week (Sunday evening works well). Set a 10-minute timer and do a quick pass through your entire apartment. Hit any area that's drifted from its reset state. This prevents the slow creep of clutter.

Seasonal: The Deep Reset

Four times a year, do a deeper version of the 1-hour reset. This time, open drawers, sort through cabinets, and reassess what you own. Donate, recycle, or discard anything that no longer serves you.

Trigger Reset: When Stress Hits

Feeling overwhelmed? Reset one zone. Just one. The act of completing a small space can shift your entire mental state. Your entryway or bathroom are great trigger-reset zones because they're small and quick.

Do This Now

Choose your daily reset time. Write it here and set a recurring reminder on your phone.

My daily 2-minute reset time:

My weekly tune-up day:

Chapter Checklist

Daily 2-minute habit time chosen and reminder set

Weekly tune-up day selected

Seasonal deep reset dates planned

Trigger reset zone identified

You Did It!

Your apartment is reset. Take a breath. Look around.
You earned this moment of calm.

Total time it took me:

My Reset Score

Before (1-10):

After (1-10):

My Next Reset Date:

Share your reset with #SmallSpaceReset

Tag @SmallSpaceHome on social media - we'd love to see your space!

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Thank you for choosing to live intentionally in your small space.